

FinTech in ASEAN 2025: Navigating the New Realities

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Foreword

Over the past decade, ASEAN's FinTech sector has evolved from a disruptive upstart to a maturing industry focused on sustainability and profitability. The region's fundamentals remain a draw to investors – a rising middle class with a vast underserved population, a thriving digital economy, and strong support from regulators.

Amidst increasing global volatility, the region's FinTech industry faces a new set of challenges.

While global FinTech funding rebounded by 13 per cent year-on-year (YoY) to US\$27.8 billion in 9M 2025, ASEAN's momentum has eased, falling to US\$835 million from US\$1.3 billion, underscoring a shift towards consolidation and disciplined capital deployment.

Despite the slowdown in deal activity, funding rounds have become larger, allocated to industry frontrunners with proven track records.

The headline numbers and underlying signals portray a shifting landscape. FinTech firms that embrace executional excellence with a clear path to profitability will continue to attract investor interest. But as AI advances, firms that are truly AI-native may well be the clear winners of the next decade.

Recent news of Timor-Leste's official accession to ASEAN, and the anticipated signing of the ASEAN Digital Economy Framework Agreement (DEFA) in 2026, provide much-needed optimism and new opportunities. As the first major regionwide digital economy agreement in the world, DEFA is set to usher in harmonised standards and guidelines, as well as improved infrastructure interoperability – something that players in the financial industry can look forward to.

As ASEAN's FinTech sector enters its second decade, we look forward to seeing the industry scale in a sustainable way, bringing innovative, inclusive solutions that will benefit the people of ASEAN.

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